**THE WEAVING**
**A 4-H Remembrance**

Once, in a sun-drenched field of clover
The girls of Spring would gather
To braid the fragrant greenery into an emerald chain
To honor one who came before.

And as they bent to their task,
The May sunshine warm on their hair,
The air was filled with their laughter
And secrets shared
And dreams revealed.
These too were intertwined
Within the weaving.

And when at last it was complete,
They raised the bulky length to their shoulders
As naturally, as gracefully,
As they would assume the mantle of their womanhood
As did their mothers and their grandmothers before them.

For they had fashioned yet another link
In the eternal chain
That binds them ever to this land of Iowa,
Of home.

1993 Honorable Mention, Adult General